

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 7 5 3
♥ J 9
♦ J 8 5 2
♣ Q 10 4

♠ J 10 9 4
♥ K Q 2
♦ A K 9
♣ K 7 6



♠ 6
♥ A 10 8 6 4
♦ 10 7 3
♣ J 8 3 2

♠ A Q 8 2
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 6 4
♣ A 9 5

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass
3NT by North

With his 4-3-3-3 distribution South chooses not to bother with Stayman. North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥6. West plays the ♥J.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=1 ♦=3 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need to get two more winners. The ♥ suit might provide one of them, but you will still have to establish ♠s. The burning question is whether to win the first ♥ or to hold up. If you take this trick you will have a second stopper if East takes the lead, but you will be in extreme danger if West takes the lead. Since the ♠ finesse has to go into West you should hold up.

West returns the ♥9, East takes the ♥A and clears the suit.

You have lost two tricks so far. Lead the ♠J and let it ride. West wins their third trick with the ♠K but has no ♥ to return so he plays a ♦ which you win with your ♦A.

Play off your 7 winners and give up a ♣ at the end.

The K Q x holding is similar to the A J x holding. It might be two stoppers, or might just be one, depending on which defender next leads the suit.

So you decide whether to hold up or not based on how you expect to play the hand.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 10 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ A K 9
♣ A 9 5

♠ 7 6 5

♥ J 9

♦ J 8 5 2

♣ Q 10 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 8 2

♥ K Q 2

♦ Q 6 4

♣ K 7 6

♠ K 3

♥ A 10 8 6 4

♦ 10 7 3

♣ J 8 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

With his 4-3-3-3 distribution West chooses not to bother with Stayman. East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♥6. North plays the ♥J.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=1 ♦=3 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need to get two more winners. The ♥ suit might provide one of them, but you will still have to establish ♠s. The burning question is whether to win the first ♥ or to hold up. If you take this trick you will have a second stopper if South takes the lead, but you will be in extreme danger if North takes the lead. Since the ♠ finesse has to go into South you should not hold up.

You win with your ♥K, (keeping South in the dark about who holds the ♥Q), enter dummy with the ♦A and play the ♠J, letting it ride to South's ♠K.

South cannot play ♥s without setting up your ♥Q so he will probably exit with a ♣ which you take with the ♣K.

Play off your 6 winners and concede the last three tricks.

This was almost the same as Deal 5, the difference being in which direction the ♠ finesse had to be taken.

But it sure makes a big difference in how you play the hand.

This might have turned out even better. If South had decided to play his partner for the ♥Q, (who would have played ♥J from a holding of ♥ Q J x), you would have made an overtrick!